

August 12, 2026

Absolute Total Care (Centene)
Provider Appeals Department

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Stanford Windler (MRN MUSC0161934), Claim MUSC-1B1C-3

Patient	Stanford Windler (DOB 1941-08-06)
MRN	MUSC0161934
Member ID / Group	ABS330201565 / GRP-63437
Claim number	MUSC-1B1C-3
Date of service	2026-05-21
Procedure billed	CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity
Primary diagnosis	J06.9 — Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified
Denied amount	\$568.93
Denial code	CARC 96 / RARC N130 — Non-covered charge(s).
Appeal deadline	2026-10-01

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health Florence Medical Center is submitting this formal first-level appeal on behalf of patient Stanford Windler (MRN: MUSC2704695, Member ID: ABS330201565) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-1B1C-3 for services rendered on May 21, 2026. The claim was denied under CARC 96 (Non-covered charge(s)) with RARC N130, accompanied by the payer remark: "Service is excluded under the member's plan benefit document." MUSC Health respectfully disputes this determination. The service at issue — a Level 4 established patient office visit (CPT 99214) — represents a medically necessary, covered outpatient evaluation for an 85-year-old patient with multiple active chronic conditions, and the denial does not appear to be supported by the clinical facts or the applicable terms of the member's Absolute Total Care PPO plan.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Mr. Windler is an 85-year-old male with an extensive and active chronic disease burden, including coronary heart disease (I25.10), chronic sinusitis, osteoporosis, gout, anemia, prediabetes, and obesity. He carries active prescriptions for cardiovascular medications including simvastatin, amlodipine, nitroglycerin, and clopidogrel, reflecting the ongoing medical management required for his coronary artery disease. On May 21, 2026, Mr. Windler presented to MUSC Health Florence Medical Center, an on-campus outpatient hospital facility (Place of Service 22), under the care of rendering provider James H. Ferrell, MD (NPI 1992837465). The encounter was billed as CPT 99214, an established patient office or outpatient visit of moderate complexity, with a primary diagnosis of acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified (J06.9), and a secondary diagnosis of coronary heart disease (I25.10). Given the patient's age, active cardiovascular disease, and polypharmacy regimen, evaluation of an acute respiratory illness in this clinical context appropriately supports the moderate complexity level assigned.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The denial characterizes CPT 99214 as a non-covered service excluded under the member's plan benefit document. MUSC Health respectfully requests that Absolute Total Care identify with specificity the plan exclusion upon which this determination rests. Routine outpatient evaluation and management services for established patients are among the most fundamental benefits provided under Medicaid managed care plans and are not customarily subject to categorical exclusion. The member's coverage period runs from January 1, 2024, through December 31, 2026, and was active at the time of service. The claim was submitted on June 5, 2026, well within timely filing requirements, and this appeal is being submitted in advance of the October 1, 2026, appeal deadline.

CPT 99214 is a standard, widely recognized evaluation and management code. Its assignment here is consistent with the documented complexity of this patient's presentation: an acute illness overlaid on active coronary heart disease requiring ongoing antiplatelet and antianginal therapy. The payer's remittance acknowledges an allowed amount of \$425.02, which itself implies the service falls within a recognized fee schedule — an acknowledgment that is difficult to reconcile with a claim that the service is wholly excluded from coverage. MUSC Health requests that Absolute Total Care reconcile this inconsistency and reconsider the denial in light of the full clinical and administrative record.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that Absolute Total Care (Centene) reverse the denial of Claim MUSC-1B1C-3 and reprocess the claim for payment at the previously established allowed amount of \$425.02, or at the contractually applicable rate. Should the plan maintain that a specific benefit exclusion applies, MUSC Health requests that the plan provide the precise exclusion language and the section of the benefit document upon which it relies, so that this matter may be further reviewed or escalated as appropriate. MUSC Health is committed to resolving this matter through the plan's established dispute resolution process and appreciates Absolute Total Care's prompt attention to this appeal.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

Senior Appeals Specialist, Revenue Cycle Management
MUSC Health — Revenue Cycle / Patient Financial Services
(843) 792-2300 | muschealth.org

Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record